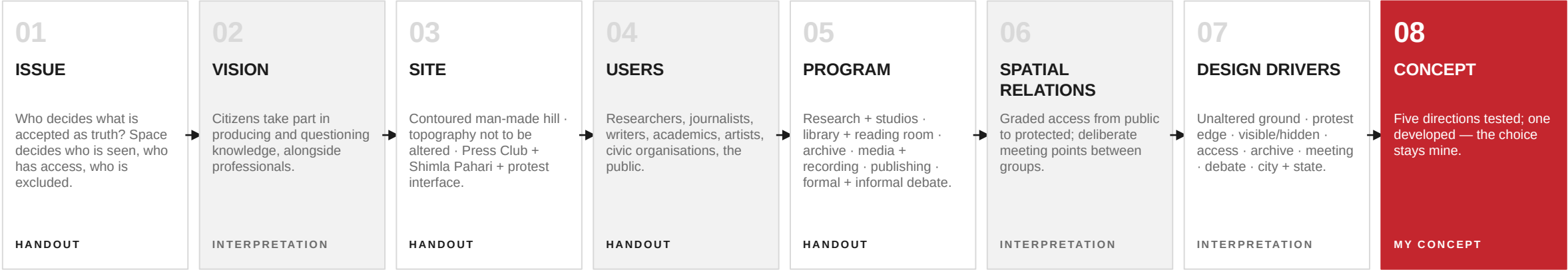
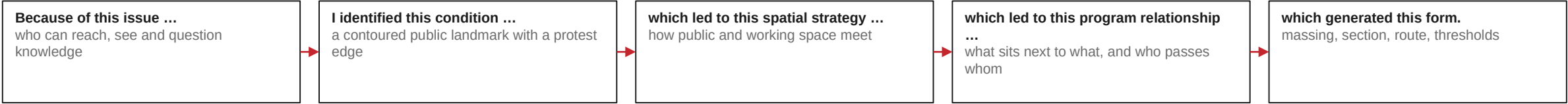


FROM ISSUE TO CONCEPT

The concept has to come out of the brief, not be put on top of it. Every step below is carried into the diagrams that follow.



HOW I WILL DEFEND ANY CONCEPT



SOURCE TAGS USED ON EVERY SLIDE

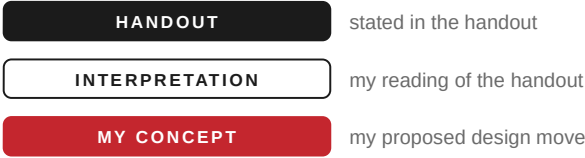
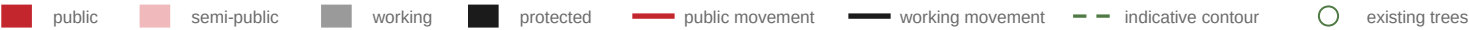


DIAGRAM LANGUAGE



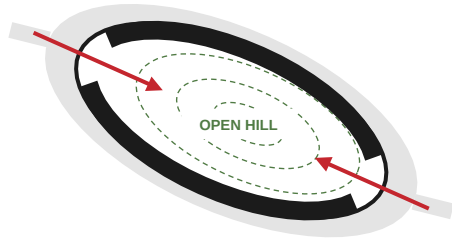
Site outline, roads and tree ring simplified from the handout site plan. Contours are INDICATIVE only (the handout states the site is contoured but gives no levels). Protest-edge position, summit and existing Press Club footprint are ASSUMED — confirm by site survey.

FIVE CONCEPT DIRECTIONS

Same brief, same site, same drivers — five different answers to “what do I actually do with the building?”

MY CONCEPT

A WRAP THE HILL



a low ring at the foot of the mound

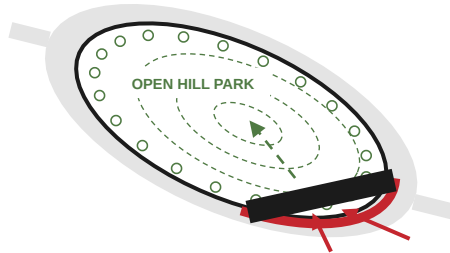
Keep the whole mound as open public ground and build a low ring around its base, so the institution becomes the threshold between the road and the hill.

WHAT I DO

① offset a band inside the boundary ② break it at the junctions ③ slope the roof up to the hill

TOPOGRAPHY Builds only on the toe; the mound's profile is extended, never cut.

B THE THICK EDGE



building the protest interface

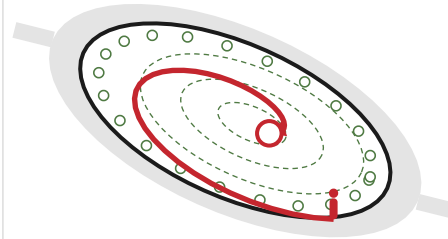
Build the protest edge itself: one thick building along the street whose ground floor is a covered public room for speech, press and gathering, with work stacked behind and above.

WHAT I DO

① extrude a bar on the edge ② lift it into an arcade ③ cut passages to the hill

TOPOGRAPHY Sits on the flat road edge; the hill is untouched and becomes the backdrop.

C THE PUBLIC ASCENT



a route from the protest edge to the summit

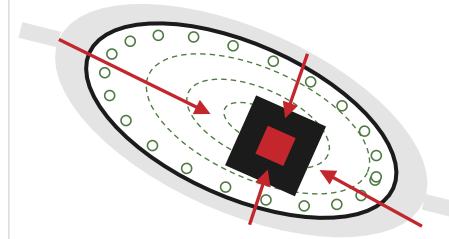
A public route climbs Shimla Pahari from the protest edge to the summit. The institution's rooms sit along it on the contours, so anyone walking up passes the making of knowledge, and the top of the landmark belongs to the public.

WHAT I DO

① draw a path edge → summit ② lay bars on the contours ③ open each bar to the path

TOPOGRAPHY Buildings follow existing levels; ground and trees kept.

D THE OPEN PRESS



production around one public room

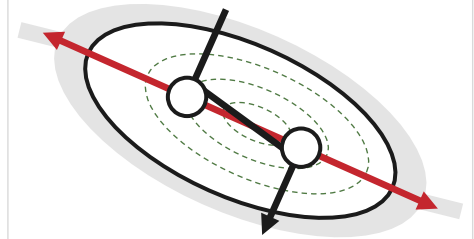
Gather all production around one public room: a compact building on ground that is already built on, with a central void that shows research, recording, publishing and the archive at work.

WHAT I DO

① place block on the existing footprint ② carve a central void ③ glaze the work towards it

TOPOGRAPHY Smallest disturbance: reuses already-built ground.

E CROSSING PATHS



two routes, shared rooms where they meet

Separate the public route from the working route, then make them cross: every crossing becomes a shared room where citizens and professionals meet.

WHAT I DO

① draw the public line ② draw the working line ③ inflate the crossings into rooms

TOPOGRAPHY Bars span across the slope on piers: ground kept, more structure needed.

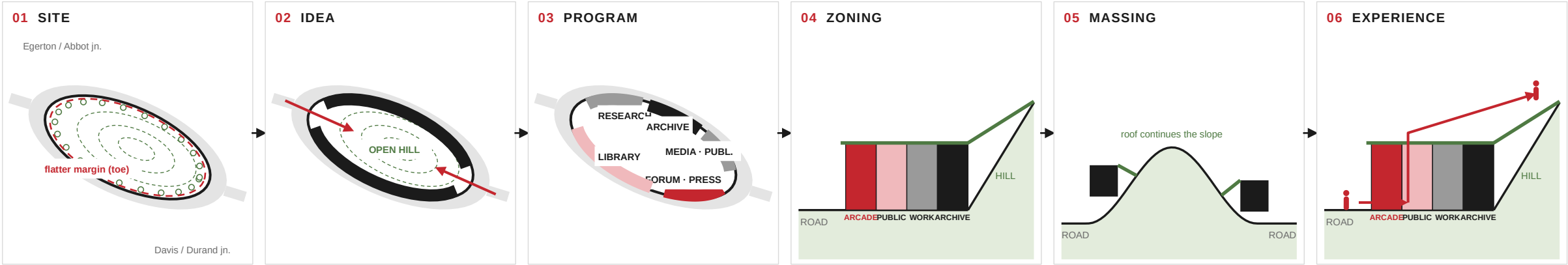
DIRECTION A — WRAP THE HILL

03

a low ring at the foot of the mound

MY CONCEPT

Keep the whole mound as open public ground and build a low ring around its base, so the institution becomes the threshold between the road and the hill.



WHY — FROM THE BRIEF

ISSUE Who owns the landmark? Instead of an image-building on top, the institution stays low and the hill stays public.

VISION Public knowledge sits at the city's edge; the hill above stays open to everyone.

SITE Uses the flatter margin between road and the toe of the mound; mound and trees untouched.

USERS Public meets the ring from the road; professionals work in the inner half facing the hill.

PROGRAM Segments: forum + press at the protest edge, library, archive, research, media, publishing around the loop.

SPACE — WHAT IT BECOMES

SPATIAL IDEA One continuous low building wrapping the hill, broken by gates at the junctions.

CIRCULATION Public loop on the road side; working corridor on the hill side; gates cross from road to hill.

PUBLIC / PRIVATE Outer face public → inner face working; archive in the thickest segment.

MASSING / FORM Long low ring, 1–2 floors; roof slopes up to meet the hill.

SECTION Road → arcade → rooms → working corridor → roof continuing onto the slope.

GROUND + EXPERIENCE

WHAT I ACTUALLY DO ① offset a band inside the boundary ② break it at the junctions ③ slope the roof up to the hill

LANDSCAPE / TOPOGRAPHY Builds only on the toe; the mound's profile is extended, never cut.

EXPERIENCE A sheltered walk along the edge; through a gate, the green hill opens up.

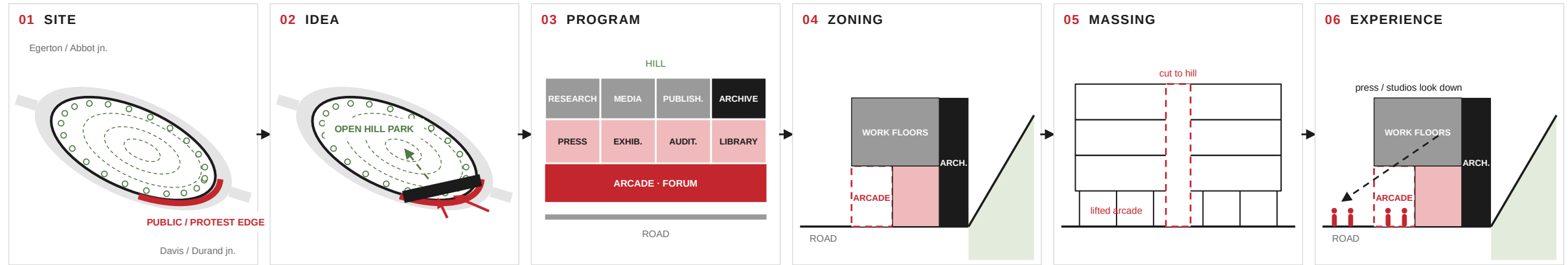
DIRECTION B — THE THICK EDGE

04

building the protest interface

MY CONCEPT

Build the protest edge itself: one thick building along the street whose ground floor is a covered public room for speech, press and gathering, with work stacked behind and above.



WHY — FROM THE BRIEF

ISSUE Public speech and media already meet at the public/protest interface; the brief asks how architecture relates citizen, media and state.

VISION Public voice gets a proper civic room at the city's edge, wired directly to the press.

SITE Concentrates building on the street edge; the rest of Shimla Pahari stays an open hill park.

USERS Protesters, public and journalists meet under the arcade; researchers and staff work above.

PROGRAM Ground: forum, press room, exhibition, auditorium. Above: library, research, media, publishing. Rear: archive.

SPACE — WHAT IT BECOMES

SPATIAL IDEA A deep linear bar with a double-height public arcade facing the road.

CIRCULATION Linear public spine at ground; cores up to working floors; passages through to the hill.

PUBLIC / PRIVATE Layered back from the street: arcade → public hall → working floors → archive at the rear.

MASSING / FORM 3–4 storey bar on the edge; lifted ground floor; one or two cuts through to the hill.

SECTION Road | arcade void | public hall | stacked work floors | archive | hill.

GROUND + EXPERIENCE

WHAT I ACTUALLY DO ① extrude a bar on the edge ② lift it into an arcade ③ cut passages to the hill

LANDSCAPE / TOPOGRAPHY Sits on the flat road edge; the hill is untouched and becomes the backdrop.

EXPERIENCE Standing in a large covered room open to the street, with press and studios looking down.

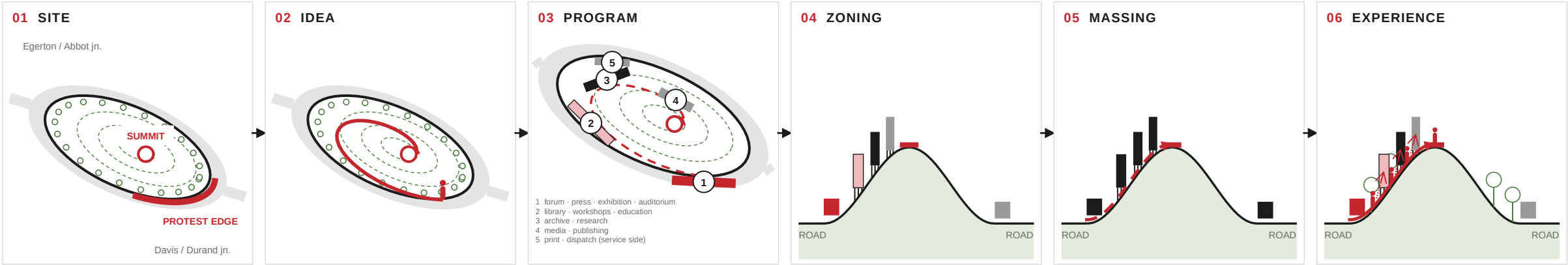
DIRECTION C — THE PUBLIC ASCENT

05

a route from the protest edge to the summit

MY CONCEPT

A public route climbs Shimla Pahari from the protest edge to the summit. The institution's rooms sit along it on the contours, so anyone walking up passes the making of knowledge, and the top of the landmark belongs to the public.



WHY — FROM THE BRIEF

ISSUE Who can reach, see and question knowledge? The route makes access and visibility physical.

VISION Citizens take part alongside professionals; the public, not the institution, owns the top of the landmark.

SITE Follows the contours: no regrading; buildings sit lightly between the trees.

USERS Public climbs the route; journalists and researchers use a direct working spine; both meet in shared rooms.

PROGRAM Ordered by height: edge = forum, press, exhibition, auditorium; lower = library, workshops; middle = archive, research; upper = media, publishing; summit = open forum.

SPACE — WHAT IT BECOMES

SPATIAL IDEA Low bars stepping up the hill, strung on one public path.

CIRCULATION Slow public switchback route + straight working spine + service loop at the base.

PUBLIC / PRIVATE Route public; each bar open on the route side, working on the hill side; archive stores protected.

MASSING / FORM 3–4 low bars (1–2 floors) parallel to the contours, stepping up on piers.

SECTION Stepped section; ground continuous under and between bars; roofs become landings.

GROUND + EXPERIENCE

WHAT I ACTUALLY DO ① draw a path edge → summit ② lay bars on the contours ③ open each bar to the path

LANDSCAPE / TOPOGRAPHY Buildings follow existing levels; ground and trees kept.

EXPERIENCE Climbing, looking into rooms at work, arriving at the top with the city below.

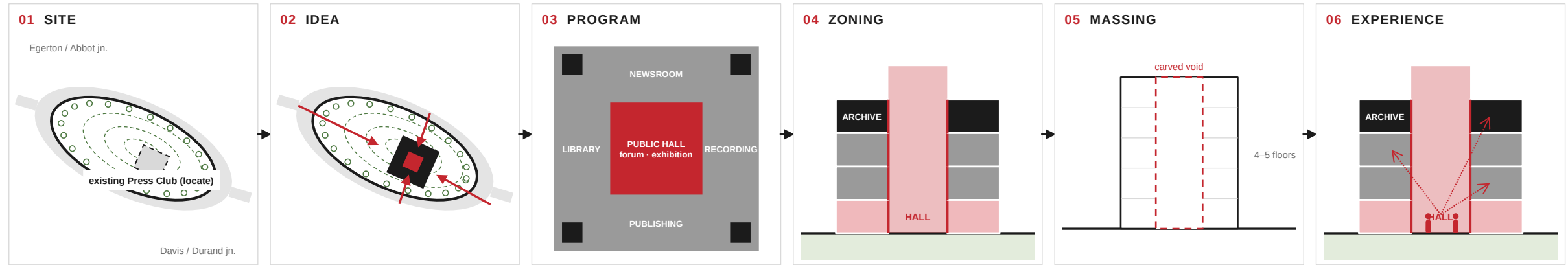
DIRECTION D — THE OPEN PRESS

06

production around one public room

MY CONCEPT

Gather all production around one public room: a compact building on ground that is already built on, with a central void that shows research, recording, publishing and the archive at work.



WHY — FROM THE BRIEF

ISSUE What is visible and what is hidden? Here the making of information is put on view.

VISION An institution open about how its knowledge is made.

SITE Builds on the existing Press Club footprint (verify), leaving the rest of the hill as park.

USERS Public in the hall; professionals on the galleries around it; eye contact across the void.

PROGRAM Hall = forum + exhibition; galleries: newsroom, recording, publishing, library, research; archive protected on top.

SPACE — WHAT IT BECOMES

SPATIAL IDEA One compact block around a full-height public void.

CIRCULATION Public at hall level and on a ramp round the void; working cores in the corners.

PUBLIC / PRIVATE Vertical: public hall → semi-public galleries → working floors → protected archive.

MASSING / FORM Compact block, 4–5 floors, carved centre.

SECTION Full-height void; glazed working floors stacked around it.

GROUND + EXPERIENCE

WHAT I ACTUALLY DO ① place block on the existing footprint ② carve a central void ③ glaze the work towards it

LANDSCAPE / TOPOGRAPHY Smallest disturbance: reuses already-built ground.

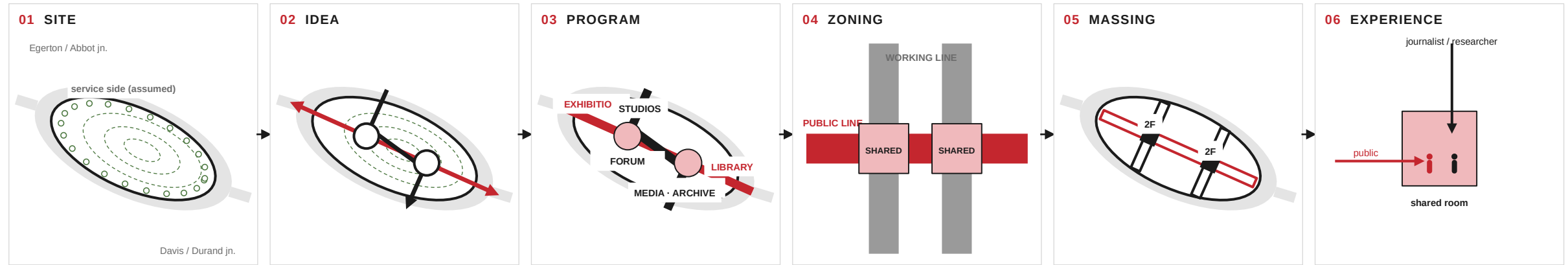
EXPERIENCE Entering a tall room where all the institution's work is visible above you.

DIRECTION E — CROSSING PATHS

two routes, shared rooms where they meet

MY CONCEPT

Separate the public route from the working route, then make them cross: every crossing becomes a shared room where citizens and professionals meet.



WHY — FROM THE BRIEF

ISSUE The brief asks for negotiation between groups that normally do not meet.

VISION Meeting is designed, not left to chance.

SITE Public line runs between the two junctions; working line crosses it from the service side.

USERS Public on one line, professionals on the other; crossings = forum, reading room, press room.

PROGRAM Public line: exhibition, library, auditorium. Working line: studios, media, publishing, archive. Crossings: shared rooms.

SPACE — WHAT IT BECOMES

SPATIAL IDEA Two interlocking linear systems with meeting nodes.

CIRCULATION Two clear circulation systems; nodes double-height.

PUBLIC / PRIVATE Public line vs working line; nodes are shared semi-public ground.

MASSING / FORM Two sets of bars at an angle; taller volumes at the crossings.

SECTION Bars bridge the slope on piers; nodes rise as double-height rooms.

GROUND + EXPERIENCE

WHAT I ACTUALLY DO ① draw the public line ② draw the working line ③ inflate the crossings into rooms

LANDSCAPE / TOPOGRAPHY Bars span across the slope on piers: ground kept, more structure needed.

EXPERIENCE Moving along your own route you arrive in a room where the other route also arrives.

COMPARING THE DIRECTIONS

No scores, no ranking — strengths, limits and what each would commit me to.

INTERPRETATION

	A WRAP THE HILL	B THE THICK EDGE	C THE PUBLIC ASCENT	D THE OPEN PRESS	E CROSSING PATHS
RELATIONSHIP TO BRIEF	Keeps the landmark public; weaker on visible production.	Answers the protest interface directly.	Ties access, visibility and meeting to one route.	Strong on visible/hidden; weaker on the protest edge.	Designs the meeting of groups directly.
SITE RESPONSE	Uses the toe; trees + mound kept.	Concentrated on the edge; hill left free.	Follows contours; claims the summit for the public.	Smallest footprint; relies on existing footprint (unknown).	Lines cut across the mound — imposed on site.
SPATIAL POTENTIAL	Long continuous edge; gates as events.	One big civic room + stacked floors.	Sequence of rooms and landings, changing views.	One powerful vertical room.	Nodes as rich shared rooms.
PROGRAM POTENTIAL	Linear chain fits; archive in thick part.	Everything fits in one bar; hill unused.	Program ordered by height and access.	Compact adjacencies; good for services.	Clear split public / working.
PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT	Strong at the road; hill above is open.	Very strong at the street; weak on the hill.	Public passes every function on the way up.	Hall is public; hill becomes backdrop.	Meeting only at nodes.
ABILITY TO GENERATE FORM	Clear ring; risk of monotony.	Easy to generate; may read as a monument.	Bars + route generate plan and form together.	Clear but risks a generic atrium block.	Diagram strong, form arbitrary on a hill.
SECTIONAL POTENTIAL	Roof-to-slope link is the key section.	Clear layered section, arcade void.	Stepped section is the concept itself.	Void section is strong and simple.	Bridging bars on piers.
TOPOGRAPHY	Extends the slope, no cuts — but ring may wall off the hill.	Flat edge only — hill untouched but unused.	Works with levels; needs care with slope access + trees.	Least disturbance, least engagement with the hill.	Spans the slope: more structure, awkward levels.

Key limitation to resolve in C: slope accessibility (ramps + lifts), security of working rooms along a public route, and footings between existing trees.

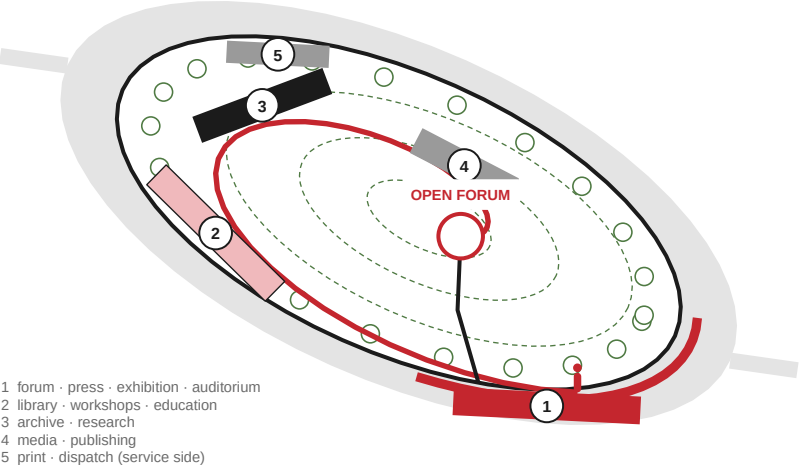
DEVELOPING DIRECTION C — THE PUBLIC ASCENT

Not declared “the best” — it is the direction where the most drivers turn into the same physical move. The final choice is mine.

MY CONCEPT

01 CONCEPT DIAGRAM

Egerton / Abbot jn.



Davis / Durand jn.

Route from protest edge to summit · rooms on the contours · working spine crosses the route

WHY IT HAS ENOUGH LOGIC TO CONTINUE

One move answers several drivers: unaltered ground (bars follow contours), protest edge (route starts there), visible/hidden (rooms open to the path), access (gradient along and across), meeting (shared path + crossings), city (summit view).

It generates plan, section and form together, so the jury can trace every decision back to the brief.

01 STATEMENT

A public route climbs Shimla Pahari from the protest edge to the summit; the rooms of knowledge sit along it on the contours; the top of the landmark stays public.

02 SITE

No regrading. Bars run parallel to contours, raised on piers between trees. Existing Press Club surveyed; option to keep it as the first stop on the route.

03 PROGRAM

Ordered by height: edge = forum, press, exhibition, auditorium · lower = library, workshops · middle = archive, research · upper = media, publishing · summit = open forum.

04 ZONING

Two directions: UP the hill (public → working) and ACROSS each bar (route side open, hill side working / protected).

05 CIRCULATION

① public switchback route (slow, open) ② working spine: straight stair + lift (fast, controlled) ③ service loop at base for print, dispatch, archive intake.

06 HIERARCHY

Open: edge, route, summit → semi-public: library, exhibition, auditorium, workshops, archive consultation → working: studios, newsroom, recording, editorial → protected: archive stores, print.

07 MASSING

3–4 low bars, 1–2 floors each, stepping up with the hill; kept low so the hill and trees still read as the landmark; summit left unbuilt.

08 SECTION

Stepped bars on piers; ground runs continuous beneath; each roof lands at the next turn of the route.

09 PUBLIC REALM

Protest edge widened into a shaded forum under existing trees; route open by day as a park path; summit forum.

10 LANDSCAPE

Trees kept as the frame; route bends around them; paving + walls in brick recall the mound's brick-kiln origin.

11 MATERIAL / ATMOSPHERE

Heavy brick for archive + back walls (protection, thermal mass); light frame + perforated brick screens on route side; shade, filtered light, glimpses in.

12 CONCEPT DIAGRAM → left

DIRECTION C — CONCEPT DIAGRAM SET

Eight diagrams, one graphic language: black/white base, red = public, grey = working, black = protected, green = ground + trees.

MY CONCEPT

01

CONCEPT

One public route, rooms on the contours, working spine across.

02

SITE RESPONSE

Bars parallel to contours; tree ring kept; no regrading.

03

PUBLIC / PRIVATE

route

one bar, across

hill

Up the hill: public → working. Across each bar: route side open.

04

USER MOVEMENT

red public · black journalist · dashed researcher · dotted service

05

PROGRAM

SUMMIT	OPEN FORUM		
UPPER	MEDIA + RECORDING	EDITORIAL · PUBLISHING	
MIDDLE	ARCHIVE	RESEARCH STUDIOS	
LOWER	LIBRARY + READING	WORKSHOPS · EDUCATION	
EDGE	FORUM · PRESS	EXHIBITION · AUDITORIUM	PRINT · DISPATCH

Program ordered by height; access decreases upward, summit reopens.

06

MASSING

roofs = landings

ROAD

ROAD

Low bars, 1–2 floors, stepping with the slope; summit unbuilt.

07

SECTION

1

2

3

4

5

1 forum · press · exhibition · auditorium
2 library · workshops · education
3 archive · research
4 media · publishing
5 print · dispatch (service side)

OPEN FORUM

Route (red) + working spine (dashed) through a stepped section.

08

PUBLIC REALM

PRESS · EXHIBITION · AUDITORIUM

FORUM UNDER TREES

ROAD · audience

route up

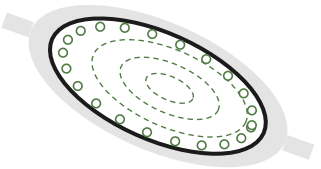
Protest edge becomes a forum under the trees; route starts here.

DIRECTION C — FORM GENERATION

Seven steps you can redraw as a strip on the board. Each step is one decision, each decision comes from a driver.

MY CONCEPT

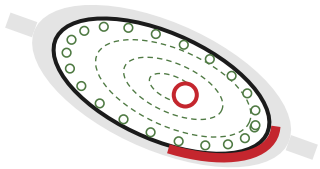
01 EXISTING HILL



Contoured mound, tree ring, roads.
Ground stays as it is.

driver: unaltered topography

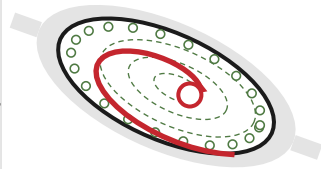
02 TWO PUBLIC CLAIMS



Mark the protest edge and the summit.

drivers: protest edge · links to city

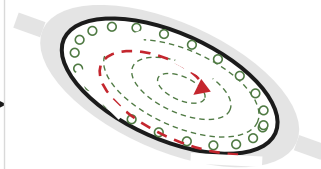
03 DRAW THE ROUTE



A slow path that follows the contours
from edge to summit.

drivers: access · meeting across users

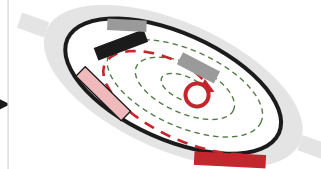
04 FIND THE STRIPS



Buildable strips between trees, parallel
to contours.

drivers: topography · trees

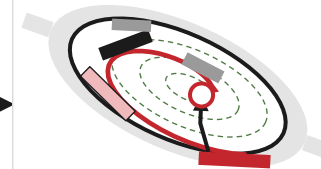
05 PLACE THE PROGRAM



Program by height: edge → library →
archive → media.

drivers: degrees of access · archive

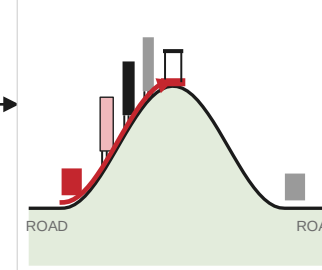
06 OPEN + CROSS



Open each bar to the route; add the
working spine.

drivers: visible / hidden · meeting

07 LEAVE THE TOP OPEN

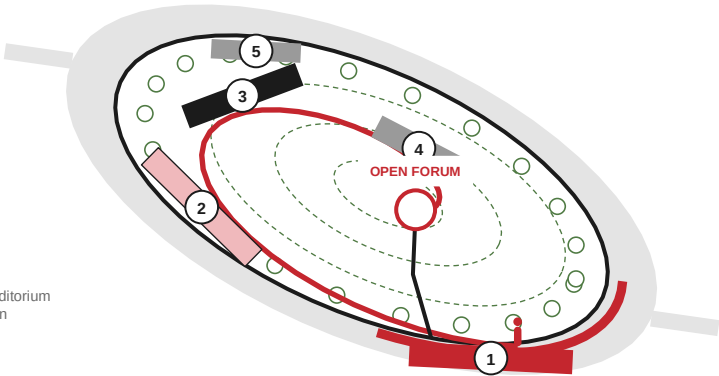


Summit = open forum; roofs =
landings; final massing.

drivers: public landmark · city + state

→ RESULTING SITE PLAN (diagrammatic)

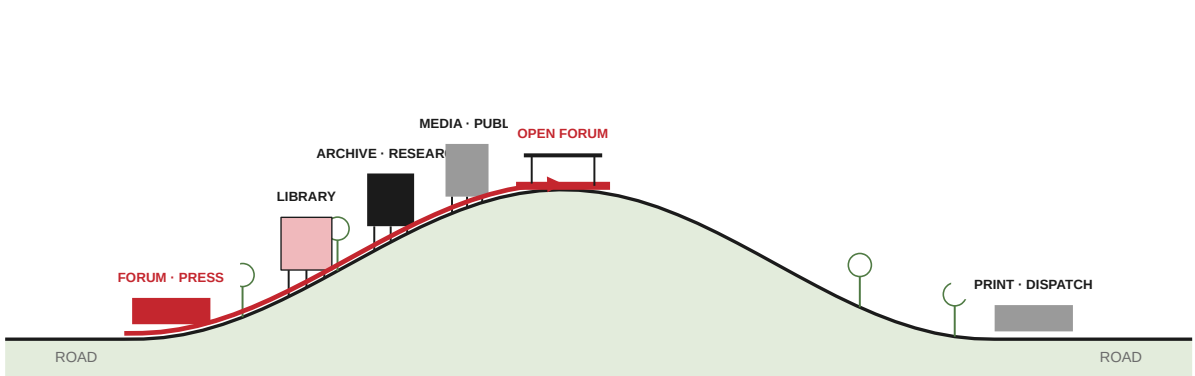
Egerton / Abbot jn.



1 forum · press · exhibition · auditorium
2 library · workshops · education
3 archive · research
4 media · publishing
5 print · dispatch (service side)

Davis / Durand jn.

→ RESULTING SECTION (diagrammatic)



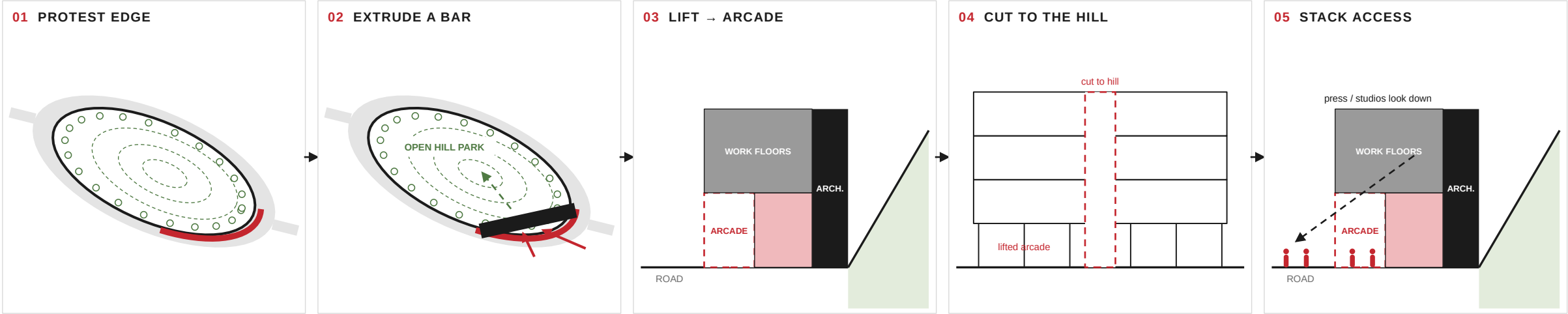
FORUM · PRESS
LIBRARY
ARCHIVE · RESEARCH
MEDIA · PUBL
OPEN FORUM
PRINT · DISPATCH

FORM GENERATION — ALTERNATIVE DIRECTIONS B + D

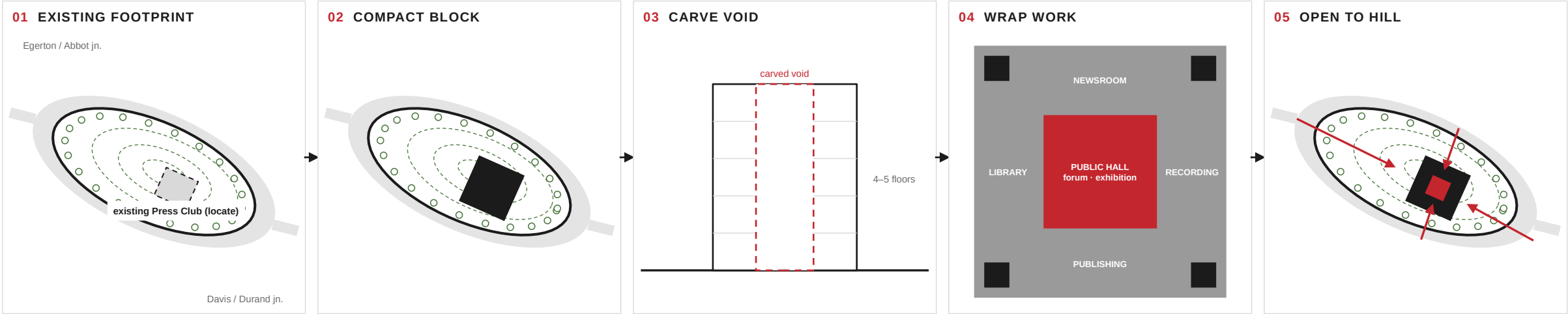
The two other directions with a clear form logic, for comparison.

MY CONCEPT

B THE THICK EDGE



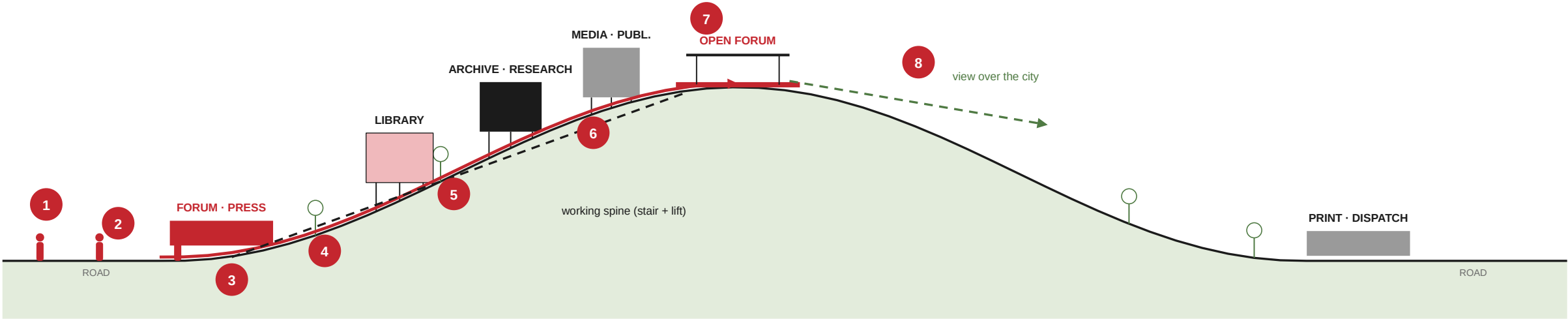
D THE OPEN PRESS



DIRECTION C — SPATIAL EXPERIENCE

What a person actually goes through, from the road to the top of Shimla Pahari.

MY CONCEPT



- 1 ARRIVAL

From the road you reach a forum under the existing trees — shade, crowd, cameras. No gate, no step up.
- 2 THRESHOLD

The edge bar's deep overhang: a compressed covered strip between street noise and the institution.
- 3 PUBLIC SPACE

Exhibition, press room and auditorium open onto the forum; you can watch a press conference from outside.
- 4 INTERACTION

The route narrows past the library; reading room windows face the path; workshops open to it.
- 5 KNOWLEDGE

Mid-hill: heavy brick archive, quiet. Consultation room on the route side; stores sealed behind.
- 6 PRODUCTION

Upper bars: studios and editorial behind brick screens; you glimpse recording and editing at work.
- 7 PUBLIC DISCUSSION

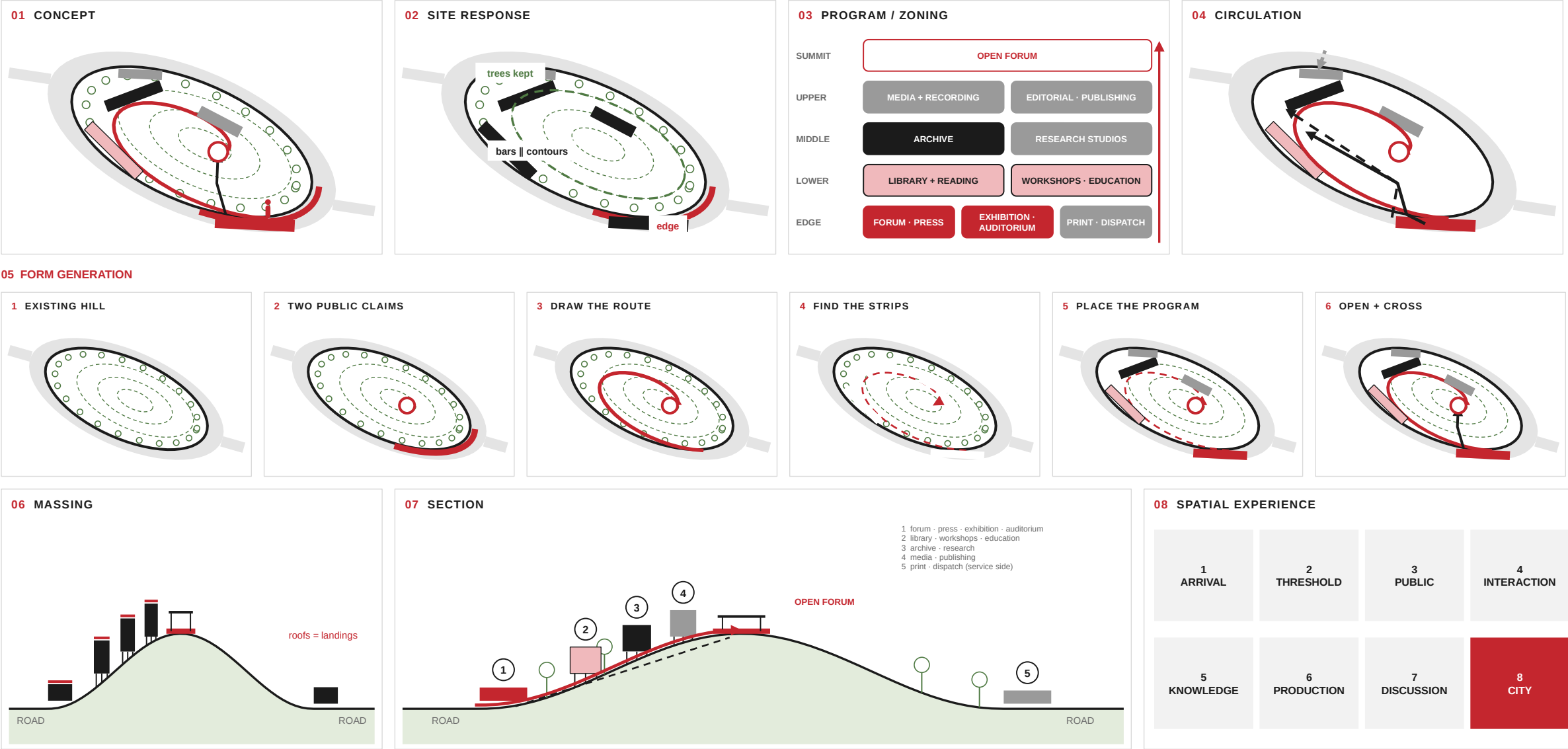
The top opens: an unbuilt forum under a light canopy, where anyone can speak.
- 8 LANDSCAPE / CITY

Release: the city spreads out below — the road you came from, and the roads towards the Assembly.

Architectural means: compression under the edge bar → release at the forum · enclosure in the archive → openness at the summit · views controlled by bar gaps · filtered light through brick screens · movement slows on the route, speeds on the spine.

THE PUBLIC ASCENT

Because the brief asks who can reach, see and question knowledge, and because the site is a contoured public landmark with a protest edge, a public route climbs Shimla Pahari from the edge to the summit. The rooms of knowledge sit along it on the contours; the top of the landmark stays public.



BOARD GUIDE — HOW TO DRAW EACH VISUAL

One graphic language throughout: thin black linework, red = public, grey = working, black poché = protected, green = ground + trees.

MY CONCEPT

VISUAL	DRAW	LABEL	ARROWS	COLOUR	SOLID / VOID	HIGHLIGHT	TEXT
Concept statement	Title + 2 lines	—	—	black; key phrase red	—	"top of the landmark stays public"	≤ 40 words
Concept diagram	Site oval, route spiral, 4 bars, spine, summit	edge · summit · bars	red route → summit; black spine	red route, grey/black bars	bars solid	route	1 line
Site response	Oval, roads, contours, tree ring, bars contours	roads, jn., trees, edge	none	green contours + trees	bars solid black	no-regrade note	1 line
Program / zoning	5 height rows: edge → summit	every program box	one upward arrow	public → protected scale	boxes solid	summit reopens (red)	1 line
Circulation	Plan with 4 lines	public · journalist · researcher · service	all end in arrowheads	red / black / dashed / grey dotted	bars light	crossings of route + spine	legend only
Form generation	6–7 small squares in a row	step name + driver	black between steps	red only for the new move	new element solid	the move of each step	1 line each
Massing	Section silhouette, bars on piers	floors (1F/2F), summit	none	black mass, red roofs	bars solid, ground hatch	roofs = landings	1 line
Section	Long section road → summit → road	all rooms, spine, route	red route; view arrow	access colours	poché ground + archive	archive mass; open summit	1–2 lines
Spatial experience	8 small frames or numbered section	8 stage names	one continuous red line	red at arrival + summit	—	compression → release	≤ 20 words each